Ubuntu • Utilities

Install 7Zip Compression Tool on Ubuntu

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How to Install 7-zip on Ubuntu and use it to compress and decompress any file or folder

When you want to transfer large size of files or folder from one location to another then you need to use any good compression tools for making the task easier. Many free tools are available to compress and decompress files and folders. One of them is 7-zip file archiver. It is an award-wining open-source file archiver with high compress ratio. This software supports most of the popular operating systems and multiple file formats. You can use this to compress and decompress files and folders in 7z, XZ, BZIP2, GZIP, TAR, ZIP and WIM formats. Some important features of this tool are mentioned below.

- It provides better compression ratio which is 2-10% better than other similar tools.
- It uses strong AES-256 encryption.
- It has self-extracting capability for 7z file format.
- It supports 87 languages

In this tutorial, you will learn how you can install and use 7-zip file archiver on Ubuntu operating system.

7-zip Installation:

Update your operating system before running the command to install 7-zip file archiver.

```
$ sudo apt-get update
```

```
ubuntu@ubuntu-VirtualBox: ~
File  Edit  View  Search  Terminal  Help
ubuntu@ubuntu-VirtualBox:~$ sudo apt-get update
[sudo] password for ubuntu:
```

p7zip package contains 7-zip. Two types of p7zip packages are available. These are p7zip and p7zip-full. If you want to make auto extractable archive also with other archive options then install p7zip-full. The command for p7zip-full package is executed here.

```
$ sudo apt-get install p7zip-full
```

```
ubuntu@ubuntu-VirtualBox:~$ sudo apt-get install p7zip-full
Reading package lists... Done
Building dependency tree
Reading state information... Done
The following additional packages will be installed:
  p7zip
Suggested packages:
  p7zip-rar
The following NEW packages will be installed:
  p7zip p7zip-full
0 upgraded, 2 newly installed, 0 to remove and 85 not upgraded.
Need to get 1,467 kB of archives.
After this operation, 5,415 kB of additional disk space will be used.
Do you want to continue? [Y/n]
```

Check the package is properly installed or not by using 7z command.

```
$ 7z
```

```
ubuntu@ubuntu-VirtualBox:~$ 7z

7-Zip [64] 16.02 : Copyright (c) 1999-2016 Igor Pavlov : 2016-05-21
p7zip Version 16.02 (locale=en_US.UTF-8,Utf16=on,HugeFiles=on,64 bits,1 CPU Inte
l(R) Core(TM) i5-6200U CPU @ 2.30GHz (406E3),ASM,AES-NI)

Usage: 7z <command> [<switches>...] <archive_name> [<file_names>...]
       [<@listfiles...>]
```

p7zip 16.02 version is installed here which contains 7-zip 16.02.

Using 7-zip

Select any file or folder to make compress file by using 7-zip. Type **ls -la** command to show the list of all files and folders of the current directory. Here, **data.txt** file is

selected for compression. The size of the file is **540** bytes.

```
$ ls -la
ubuntu@ubuntu-VirtualBox:~$ ls -la
total 144
drwxr-xr-x 21 ubuntu ubuntu  4096 Feb 12 00:21 .
drwxr-xr-x  3 root   root    4096 Feb 11 09:37 ..
-rw-------  1 ubuntu ubuntu  5246 Feb 11 23:45 .bash_history
-rw-r--r--  1 ubuntu ubuntu   220 Feb 11 09:37 .bash_logout
-rw-r--r--  1 ubuntu ubuntu  3956 Feb 11 14:34 .bashrc
drwx------ 17 ubuntu ubuntu  4096 Feb 11 21:46 .cache
drwxr-xr-x  4 ubuntu root    4096 Feb 11 13:22 .composer
-rw-r--r--  1 ubuntu ubuntu     4 Feb 11 13:25 composer.json
drwxr-xr-x 15 ubuntu ubuntu  4096 Feb 11 22:36 .config
-rw-r--r--  1 ubuntu ubuntu   540 Feb 12 00:21 data.txt
drwxrwxrwx  2 ubuntu ubuntu  4096 Feb 11 09:46 Desktop
drwxrwxrwx  2 ubuntu ubuntu  4096 Feb 11 09:46 Documents
drwxrwxrwx  2 ubuntu ubuntu  4096 Feb 11 09:46 Downloads
-rwxrwxrwx  1 ubuntu ubuntu  8980 Feb 11 09:37 examples.desktop
```

Run the command to create compressed file named **data.7z**. The option **a** is for archive or compress. After compression, the size of archive file is **152** bytes.

```
$ 7z a data.7z data.txt
ubuntu@ubuntu-VirtualBox:~$ 7z a data.7z data.txt

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p7zip Version 16.02 (locale=en_US.UTF-8,Utf16=on,HugeFiles=on,64 bits,1 CPU Inte
l(R) Core(TM) i5-6200U CPU @ 2.30GHz (406E3),ASM,AES-NI)

Scanning the drive:
1 file, 540 bytes (1 KiB)

Creating archive: data.7z

Items to compress: 1


Files read from disk: 1
Archive size: 152 bytes (1 KiB)
Everything is Ok
ubuntu@ubuntu-VirtualBox:~$
```

To show the detail information list of any archive file, run **7z** command with **l** option.

```
$ 7z l data.7z
```

```
ubuntu@ubuntu-VirtualBox:~$ 7z l data.7z

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p7zip Version 16.02 (locale=en_US.UTF-8,Utf16=on,HugeFiles=on,64 bits,1 CPU Intel
(R) Core(TM) i5-6200U CPU @ 2.30GHz (406E3),ASM,AES-NI)

Scanning the drive for archives:
1 file, 152 bytes (1 KiB)

Listing archive: data.7z

--
Path = data.7z
Type = 7z
Physical Size = 152
Headers Size = 122
Method = LZMA2:12
Solid = -
Blocks = 1

   Date      Time    Attr         Size   Compressed  Name
------------------- ----- ------------ ------------  ------------------------
2018-02-12 00:21:22 ....A          540           30  data.txt
------------------- ----- ------------ ------------  ------------------------
2018-02-12 00:21:22                540           30  1 files
ubuntu@ubuntu-VirtualBox:~$
```
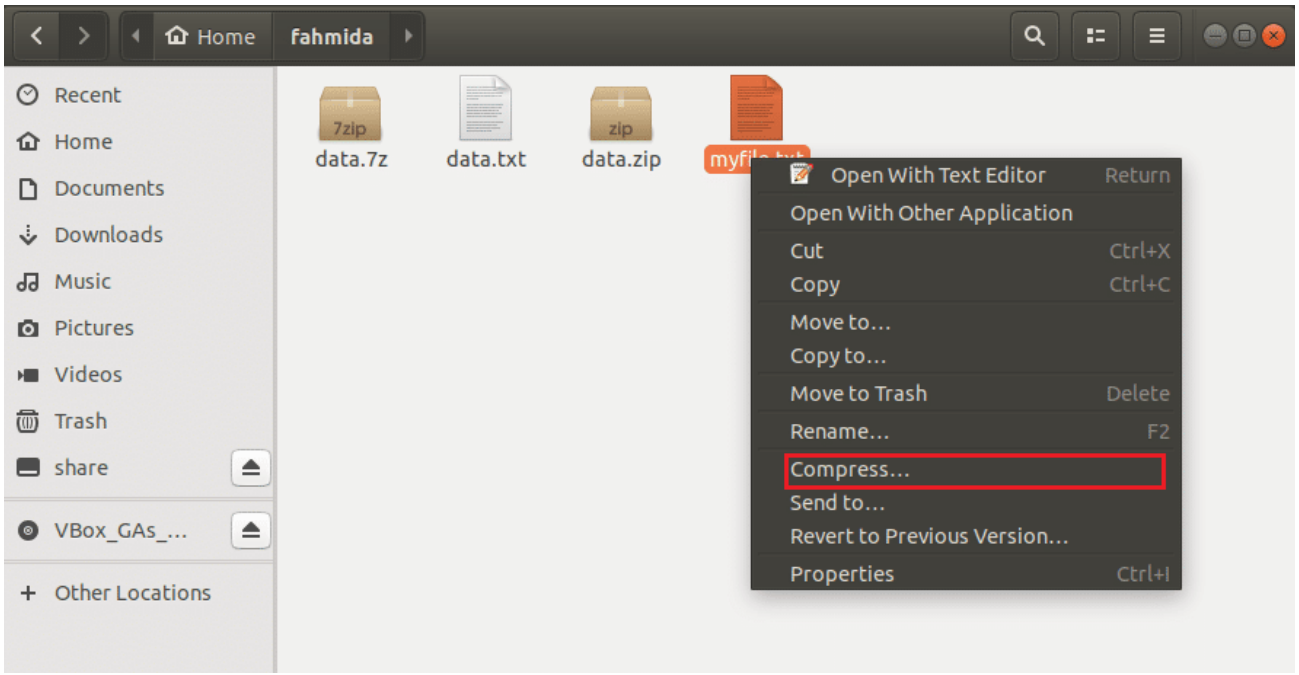
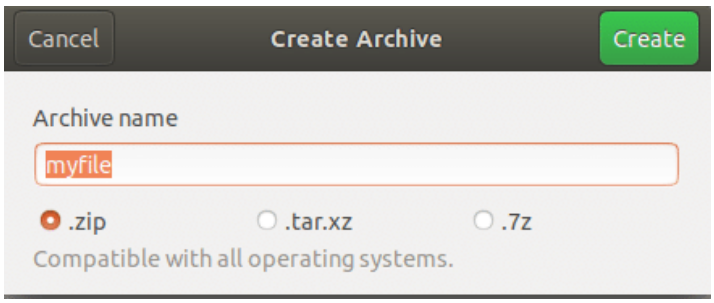

Run **7z** command with **e** option to decompress or extract the files and folder from a archive file.

```
$ 7z e data.7z
ubuntu@ubuntu-VirtualBox:~/fahmida$ 7z e data.7z

7-Zip [64] 16.02 : Copyright (c) 1999-2016 Igor Pavlov : 2016-05-21
p7zip Version 16.02 (locale=en_US.UTF-8,Utf16=on,HugeFiles=on,64 bits,1 CPU Intel
(R) Core(TM) i5-6200U CPU @ 2.30GHz (406E3),ASM,AES-NI)

Scanning the drive for archives:
1 file, 152 bytes (1 KiB)

Extracting archive: data.7z
--
Path = data.7z
Type = 7z
Physical Size = 152
Headers Size = 122
Method = LZMA2:12
Solid = -
Blocks = 1

Everything is Ok

Size:       540
Compressed: 152
ubuntu@ubuntu-VirtualBox:~/fahmida$
```

By using above steps you can create archive file of any folder also. You can create archive file of files and folders without using commands or terminal. Go to file location, select the file and right click on it to open pop-up menu. Click compress option from menu to create archive file.



Three archive options are available in the dialog box which are **.zip, .tar.xz, .7z.** Here, **.zip** is selected to create a compressed file named **myfile.zip**.



7-zip archiver is an efficient tool to compress and decompress your necessary files and folder. You can easily transfer large amount of data by using this archiver.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

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I am a trainer of web programming courses. I like to write article or tutorial on various IT topics. I have a YouTube channel where many types of tutorials based on Ubuntu, Windows, Word, Excel, WordPress, Magento, Laravel etc. are published: Tutorials4u Help.

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